Mikel *Rosenthal*

DESIGN SYSTEM ARCHITECT · SENIOR PRODUCT DESIGNER · AI-ASSISTED DESIGN ENGINEER

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I. SUMMARY

Design system architect and senior product designer with 23 years in design and 10 years focused on building systems that teams adopt. Treats a system as a product: tokens in Figma Variables and Tokens Studio, component architecture with every state designed, WCAG accessibility built in, and the documentation and governance that keep contributions consistent as it grows. Led visual design and helped build Pathfinder at **Avant**, supporting the consolidation of 16 legacy products into five; created FIBER at **Blue Cross Blue Shield** and TUCM at **TransUnion**; and contributed to **GE Healthcare's** Edison, a foundation unifying 40+ regulated products (2020 Red Dot for Interface Design). Works alongside engineering from design through implementation, and uses Claude Code, Figma Make and agent workflows to prototype and document faster, exploring how AI can connect Figma, design systems and code. Brings a branding and visual-craft eye to typography, hierarchy, color and motion.

II. EXPERIENCE

PBK Studio *Principal Designer*

MAY 2026 – PRESENT

DESIGN SYSTEMS · PRODUCT · BRAND · WEB · MOTION · VOICE · AI-NATIVE WORKFLOWS · DESIGN ENGINEERING

Independent, multidisciplinary designer creating design systems and AI-augmented product experiences for enterprise and consumer clients, with a workflow that runs from Figma to production code.

- Builds token-based, accessible (WCAG) component systems in Figma with documentation, contribution patterns and developer handoff built in, extended into production code with Claude Code and Figma Make while every craft decision stays human.
- Extends the work into brand identity, motion and original music and voice for clients who want one cohesive practice.

Verizon *Senior Design System Designer II*

NOV 2025

SHORT-TERM CONTRACT VIA INSIGHT GLOBAL · FULLY REMOTE

Scoped contract on Verizon's post-rebrand enterprise design system, delivering accessible, token-based components. Designed each component with full states and accessibility on the system's existing tokens and variables.

The Bettering Company *Brand Designer*

JAN 2025 – AUG 2025

FREELANCE · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Built a new brand identity and lightweight design system, translating the company's core values into a cohesive visual language and shipping-ready guidelines.

- Generated and refined a wide range of logo concepts — exploring form, symbolism, and narrative to capture the brand's mission.
- Established brand guidelines and flexible foundations for consistent application across digital and physical touchpoints.

Avant *Senior Product, UI/UX & Design Systems*

MAY 2021 – AUG 2024

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Led visual design for Avant's Pathfinder Design System and a marketing design library spanning product and brand, as the system's design owner within a product team of one PM and three engineers.

- Supported the consolidation of 16 legacy products into five, working with developers to turn design decisions into reusable components and implementation guidance.
- Defined the visual language and component architecture that kept multi-platform work consistent.
- Designed dense, data-heavy advisor tooling in a dark-themed product UI; partnered with engineering on reusable Figma libraries and themeable variants.
- Introduced a brand/marketing design library that streamlined consistency for 350+ marketers.

GE Healthcare *Senior UX/UI Product Designer, Design Systems*

JAN 2020 – FEB 2021

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Core contributor to the award-winning Edison Design System — designed and evangelized modules as part of the team behind a foundation unifying 40+ regulated clinical and enterprise healthcare products.

- Developed scalable Figma component libraries and UX documentation adopted across diverse clinical product teams and device surfaces.
- Central role in winning the 2020 Red Dot Award, Fast Company Innovation by Design, and dmi:DVA Award for Interface Design.
- Partnered with accessibility and compliance teams to ensure usability across regulated healthcare environments.

SurePeople *Lead UX/UI Visual Product Designer*

JUN 2020 – SEP 2020

CONTRACT · REMOTE / CHICAGO, IL

Led UX and visual design of the PRISM psychometric platform, translating complex behavioral data into clear, human-readable visualization.

- Defined interaction models, visual hierarchy, and IA for complex data visualization; built the platform's modular UI system from scratch in Figma.

Blue Cross Blue Shield *Senior Product / Design Systems Designer*

MAY 2018 – DEC 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Created and maintained the FIBER Design System — a coded, production-ready framework that accelerated product-to-market timelines.

- Defined typography, color, grids, and iconography; partnered with engineering on themeable, documented components.
- Partnered with engineering on design-to-code handoff; mentored teams in accessibility and documentation standards.

TransUnion *Senior UX Designer, Design Systems*

MAY 2018 – JUN 2019

CONTRACT · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Designed the global TUCM Design System and visual identity for customer-facing and internal applications.

- Built responsive, scalable UI libraries and universal style guidelines.

Maven Wave / Eviden *UX Team Senior Lead, Design Systems*

JAN 2013 – MAY 2018

FULL-TIME · HYBRID / CHICAGO, IL

Directed conceptual and visual direction across Fortune 500 client projects, integrating UX principles with brand storytelling.

- Established scalable design workflows and early design-system patterns for clients including Google, AT&T, and Nike.
- Created prototypes, journey maps, and digital ecosystems across app, web, and co-branded products; mentored design teams.

Earlier Experience

JAN 2003 – JAN 2013

- **Biersma Creative** (merged into Maven Wave) — *Senior Designer & UX Lead*, JAN 2005 – JAN 2013. Led visual brand and UX direction across healthcare, retail, and entertainment for clients including Aflac, AbbVie, Crate & Barrel, Disney, Google, Nike, Herman Miller, and Salesforce.
- **Firebelly Design** — *Junior Graphic Designer*, JAN 2003 – JAN 2005. Concept-to-execution brand and web design; print and digital for ComEd, Petco, Harris Bank, and Scholastic.

III. SKILLS

Design Systems	Design Tokens (Figma Variables · Tokens Studio) · Component Architecture · Governance & Contribution · Documentation · Accessibility (WCAG 2.2) · Design-to-Code Handoff
Product & Visual	UI & Visual Design Craft · Typography · Layout & Composition · Color · Interaction & Motion · Micro-Interactions · Native Mobile UI (Apple HIG · Material Design) · Cross-Platform (iOS · Android · Web) · High-Fidelity Prototyping · Complex Data Visualization · Regulated Healthcare & Enterprise UI · Art Direction & Brand
AI & Code	AI-Accelerated Workflow · Claude Code · Figma Make · Agent Workflows · Generative Exploration · HTML/CSS
Tools	Figma · Adobe Creative Suite

IV. AWARDS & EDUCATION

2020 Red Dot Award — Interface Design
EDISON DESIGN SYSTEM · GE HEALTHCARE

2020 Fast Company — Innovation by Design

2020 dmi:DVA — Design Value Award

Missouri State University · Springfield, MO
BFA, SUMMA CUM LAUDE — ELECTRONIC ARTS & DESIGN
MINOR: MASS MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS

WORK MIKELROSENTHAL.COM ART PITCHBLACKNIGHT.COM

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